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DESIGN CODE NS 10

Willow the Bunny Lovey

US crochet terms · Advanced beginner · 2-3 hours

A bunny comforter: a soft stuffed head above a light, drapey blanket body. Baby items are the single strongest category on Etsy, and a lovey carries a far higher price than a plain toy because it reads as a keepsake.

Willow's blanket is about **26 cm (10 in) square**, her head is about **4.9 cm (2 in)** across, and she measures roughly **33 cm (13 in)** from the ear tips to the opposite bottom corner.

SAFETY — READ THIS FIRST

Willow has **no safety eyes, no buttons, no beads and no removable parts**, and her face is embroidered with floss knotted inside the head. That makes her face safer than a safety-eyed toy.

It does not make her a tested toy. Willow has not been tested to a toy-safety standard such as ASTM F963 or EN 71, and no homemade lovey should be described as "baby-safe" without that testing.

Comforters are **not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months** and should be used with supervision. Put that note in your listing — it is the correct guidance, and buyers look for it.

Every seam on Willow should be sewn twice, and every end woven in for at least 5 cm and trimmed close. Loose ends are a genuine hazard on a baby item, not just an untidy finish.

MATERIALS

Yarn — DK (#3) 100% cotton, or a blend with a baby-safe certification, about 60 g. Cream, sage, dusty pink or pale grey.

Hook — 3.5 mm (US E/4) for the blanket. Use 3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose; the head needs to be tight enough that stuffing cannot show.

Eyes — None. The face is embroidered.

Floss — Dark brown or charcoal cotton floss for the face. Knot every end inside the head.

Also needed — Polyester fiber fill, about 8 g; tapestry needle; stitch marker.

Only the head is stuffed. The blanket stays flat and drapey, which is the point.

GAUGE

DK cotton on a 3.5 mm hook: about **4.3 mm per stitch** and **3.8 mm per round**.

Check it on the blanket after Rnd 3. Count the double crochets along one edge: three rounds gives 9 dc, which should measure about 39 mm. If your stitches are narrower than 4.3 mm the blanket will come out small — every size figure in this pattern depends on that number, and it is worth 2 cm on the finished square.

FINISHED SIZE

Blanket, 20 rounds	60 dc × 4.3 mm = about 26 cm square
Head	36 sts × 4.3 mm = 155 mm around = about 4.9 cm across
Head height	14 rnd × 3.8 mm = about 5.3 cm
Ear tips to opposite corner	about 33 cm

The blanket grows about **1.3 cm per round on every side**, so you can size it:

rounds	blanket
18	about 23 cm
20	about 26 cm
22	about 28 cm

ABBREVIATIONS

MR	magic ring
ch	chain
sc	single crochet
dc	double crochet
inc	increase — 2 sc in one stitch
dec	invisible decrease
sl st	slip stitch
FO	fasten off
(n)	the stitch count at the end of that round

WORKING NOTES

The **head and ears** are worked in a continuous spiral — do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds. Mark the first stitch of every spiral round.

The **blanket** is worked in **joined rounds**: each round closes with a slip stitch and the next begins with a turning chain. This is a different rhythm from the spiral, and it is what lets the square grow outward evenly.

Unless a note says otherwise, work every stitch through both loops.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

The core techniques, in the order you meet them.

1 • The magic ring. The head and each ear begin with a magic ring. Pull the tail tight once the first round is complete.

2 • Work in a spiral. Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round. There is no join to count from.

3 • The granny-square corner. Every blanket corner is worked as **(3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into one corner space**. Those four corners are what make the piece square instead of round. Miss one corner group on one round and the whole square pulls out of true — check all four at the end of every round.

4 • The border round. One round of single crochet around the finished edge, with 3 sc into each corner space. It squares the edge off and stops the blanket curling. Do not skip it.

1 • HEAD

Worked as a slightly flattened sphere so it lies comfortably against a cot mattress.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] × 6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] × 6	(24)	ears attach at R4–R6
R5	[3 sc, inc] × 6	(30)	
R6	[4 sc, inc] × 6	(36)	head at full width
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	face on R8–R10
R9	sc in each st around	(36)	

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS	NOTE
R10	[4 sc, dec] ×6	(30)	
R11	[3 sc, dec] ×6	(24)	stuff firmly
R12	[2 sc, dec] ×6	(18)	
R13	[sc, dec] ×6	(12)	top up the stuffing
R14	dec ×6	(6)	

Finish. FO and close with the tail. The finished head is about 4.9 cm across and 5.3 cm tall.

Stuff the head firmly. A soft head on a lovey collapses the moment a baby grips it, and the embroidered face distorts with it. Firm is correct here even though the blanket is soft.

2 · EARS — make 2

Long and floppy — the part a baby actually holds.

RND	INSTRUCTION	STS
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)
R2	[sc, inc] ×3	(9)
R3	[2 sc, inc] ×3	(12)
R4	sc in each st around	(12)
R5	sc in each st around	(12)
R6	sc in each st around	(12)
R7	sc in each st around	(12)
R8	sc in each st around	(12)
R9	[2 sc, dec] ×3	(9)
R10	sc in each st around	(9)
R11	[sc, dec] ×3	(6)

Finish. Do not stuff. Flatten. FO with a long tail.

Sew the ears to **Rnds 4-6** of the head, about **10 stitches apart**, and pinch the base of each so it flops forward. Unstuffed ears are safer and far more pleasant to hold.

3 · BLANKET BODY

Worked in **joined rounds** from the center out, as a four-corner granny-style square in plain double crochet.

Ch 4 and sl st to the first ch to form a ring.

Rnd 1. Ch 3 (counts as the first dc), 2 dc into the ring, [ch 2, 3 dc into the ring] ×3, ch 2, sl st to the top of the ch 3. **[12 dc, 4 corner spaces]**

Rnd 2. Sl st into the next corner space. Ch 3, 2 dc in the same space, ch 2, 3 dc in the same space — this makes the first corner. Then into each remaining corner space work (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc). Sl st to close. **[24 dc, 4 corners]**

Rnds 3-20. Continue in the same way: into every **corner space** work (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc), and into every space **along a side** work 3 dc.

Each round adds one 3-dc group to every side, so the count grows by **12 dc per round**:

RND	TOTAL DC
3	36
5	60
10	120
15	180
20	240

At Rnd 20 that is **60 dc along each edge**, which at 4.3 mm per dc gives a square about 26 cm across — the standard lovey size.

Count your four corners at the end of every round. A round with only three (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) groups is the most common mistake in a granny square, and it will not show up until the blanket is half finished.

Border

Work one final round of sc all the way around: **1 sc into each dc and 3 sc into each corner space**. Sl st to close and FO.

At Rnd 20 that is 240 sc plus 12 into the corners = **252 sc**.

This firms up the edge and stops the square from curling.

4 · FACE AND ASSEMBLY

Face

Embroider only — no safety eyes, no beads, no buttons.

With dark brown floss, work two small oval eyes about **8 stitches apart** across **Rnds 8-9**, a small inverted-triangle nose centered between and below them, and a shallow Y for the mouth.

Knot every end inside the head and bury the tails before you close it. On a baby item a tail that works loose is not a small problem.

Blush

Skip it. Pastel and chalk blush rubs off onto bedding and is not washable.

Joining

Center the head over one corner of the square, overlapping the blanket by about 3 cm. Sew all the way around the base of the head, **then sew it a second time**.

This is the only structural seam on the piece, and it will be pulled, chewed and washed. A single pass is not enough.

Finishing

Weave in every end for at least 5 cm and trim close.

5 · WHAT TO PUT IN YOUR LISTING

Materials. 100% cotton, embroidered face, no safety eyes, no buttons, no beads, no removable parts.

Care. Machine wash cool on a gentle cycle inside a mesh bag. Reshape while damp and dry flat. Do not tumble dry — it will felt and shrink the blanket.

Supervision. Comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision.

Stating all three plainly raises conversion on baby listings. Buyers search for "no safety eyes" and "machine washable" — but do not claim "baby-safe" as a test result you have not had. "Embroidered face, no small parts" says the same thing to a buyer and is a claim you can stand behind.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Blanket curls at the edges — You skipped the final sc border round. It is what squares the edge off.

Square is not square — Every corner needs (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc). Missing a corner group on one round pulls the whole square out of true, and it compounds every round after.

Blanket came out too small — Your gauge is tighter than 4.3 mm per dc. Count 9 dc along an edge after Rnd 3: if they measure under 39 mm, go up a hook size or add rounds.

Head flops over — Stuff it firmly and sew the base seam twice. The head must sit up off the blanket.

Face looks harsh — Use fewer strands of floss and keep the eyes small and well spaced.

Too small for a lovey — Add rounds. Each extra round adds about 1.3 cm to each side, so 22 rounds gives

a 28 cm comforter.

COLORWAYS

Cream, sage, dusty pink, pale grey and butter yellow. Neutrals outsell brights in the baby category by a wide margin.

BEFORE YOU ASSEMBLE

Lay every component out and check it against the pattern before you sew anything:

- 1 head, firmly stuffed
- 2 ears, flat and unstuffed
- 1 blanket square with the border worked

Pin the head to the corner and look at Willow from the front before committing a single stitch.

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